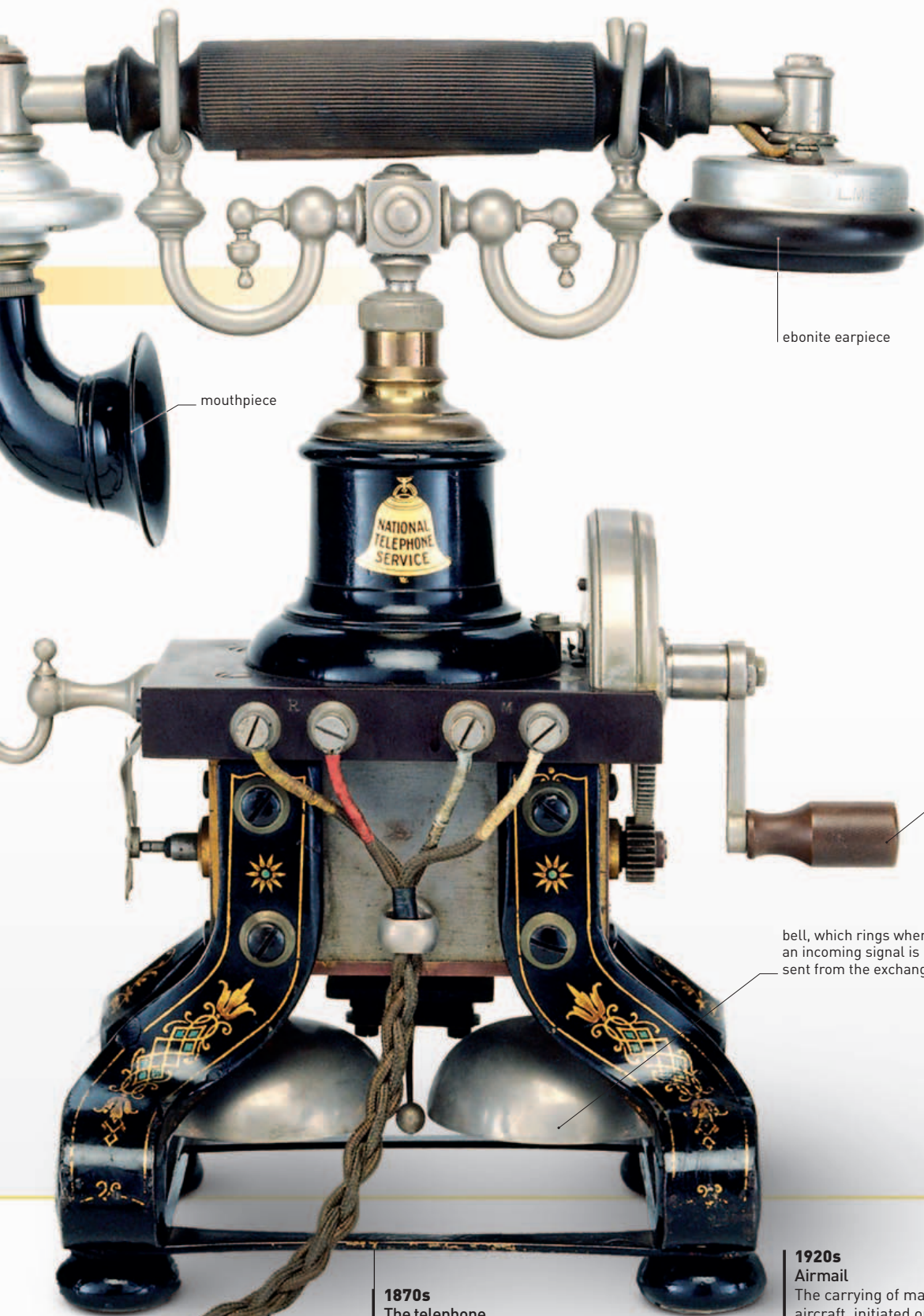




ebonite earpiece

mouthpiece

“ THAT’S
AN AMAZING
INVENTION, BUT
WHO WOULD EVER
WANT TO USE ONE
OF THEM? ”

Rutherford B. Hayes, US President, to Alexander Graham Bell after a demonstration of the telephone, 1876

crank, which drives a
dynamo to send a signal
to the exchangebell, which rings when
an incoming signal is
sent from the exchange

Early table telephone

Made of metal, the Ericsson table telephone dates from 1890. It combined the transmitter and receiver into a single handset. The handle cranked a generator that rang a bell at the telephone exchange to contact the operator.

1870s

The telephone

Inventors, including American Alexander Graham Bell, demonstrate early telephones in the US. The first telephone exchanges in North America and Europe date from 1878.

1920s

Airmail

The carrying of mail by aircraft, initiated on a small scale before World War I, becomes important, transforming delivery times on long-distance routes.

Apple
iPhone

Early 21st century

Mobile communication

Mobile phone usage becomes a mass phenomenon in the first decade of the 21st century.

Penny
Black

1837–40

Postage stamp

Britain introduces a low, uniform rate for postage, paid by buying an adhesive stamp.

1850s–60s

Transatlantic cable Telegraph cables laid across the Atlantic seabed allow messages to be exchanged between Europe and North America in minutes.

Early 1900s

Radio

Wireless telegraphy and sound transmission developed, leading to radio broadcasting.



Wireless

1920s–30s

Television

Transmission of moving images leads to public television broadcasting, though few people own televisions until the 1950s.

1960s

Communication satellites

Telstar enables the first live transatlantic television broadcast in 1962.



Telstar

Late 20th century

The Internet

Global computer networks create instant communication through email.